INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #16 · RELATIVES

“My family will never change.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Family patterns can feel carved in stone: the same arguments, the same favorites, the same silence about hard things. After years of hoping and trying, it is natural to conclude that nothing will ever be different. Disappointment can turn into resignation or into a quiet bitterness.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.” God promises, “I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you.” In Scripture, God changed the hearts of people who seemed hopeless, as in the story of the prodigal son. Proverbs says, “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases.” At the same time, we are told, “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone.” We cannot force change, but we can pray, do our part, and keep our own hearts from hardening.

> *“Jesus looked at them and said, ‘With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.’”* (Matthew 19:26).

Also see

> “I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh” (Ezekiel 36:26).

> “So he got up and went to his father. But while he was still in the distance, his father saw him and was filled with compassion. He ran to his son, embraced him, and kissed him” (Luke 15:20).

> “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone” (Romans 12:18).

> “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases” (Proverbs 21:1).

Common self-statements

- They are who they are.
- Nothing I do makes any difference.
- Every holiday is the same.
- They will never see the truth.
- It is pointless to try again.
- I have to accept it forever.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that no change will ever occur.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing change is either total or impossible.
- Mental filter: Focusing on what has not changed and missing small shifts.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling hopeless and concluding it is hopeless.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I want my family to change?
- Has anything shifted over the years, even a little?

- What part of this is mine to change, such as my responses or expectations?
- What can I do differently while I pray for them?
- What does Scripture say about God's power to change hearts?
- How can I protect my own peace?

Truth summary

> I cannot make my family change, but I do not have to give up hope. God can change hearts, and I can change my own responses. I can pray, set healthy limits, and live well whether or not they change.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Forgiveness
- Prayer, Answers to
- Love, For Others
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Depression
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "My family will never change"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My family will never change." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I want to change?
- ☐ What small shifts have I seen?
- ☐ What is mine to change?
- ☐ What will I do differently?
- ☐ How can I pray?
- ☐ How will I protect my peace?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ With God all things are possible.
- ☐ God can give a new heart.
- ☐ I can change my part.
- ☐ I do not have to carry their change.
- ☐ I can pray and hope.
- ☐ I can protect my peace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 19:26**
  "Jesus looked at them and said, 'With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.'"
- ☐ **Ezekiel 36:26**
  "I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh."
- ☐ **Romans 12:18**
  "If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ My part: Each week, write one thing you did differently in your own responses.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 19:26 becomes: "Sarah can write: "With God all things are possible, even for my family.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name what you want. Write the specific change you hope for.
- ☐ Divide the control. Write what is yours to change and what is not.
- ☐ Pray by name. Pray for each family member for a week.
- ☐ Adjust your expectations. Decide how you will respond next time without waiting for change.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My family will never change": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	My part changed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My family will never change.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, with You all things are possible. I place my family in Your hands. Change what only You can change, and change me where I need it. Give me peace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #17 · RELATIVES

"I have to keep everyone in my family happy."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some of us became the family peacekeeper early, learning to read moods and smooth things over before anyone exploded. We may have been rewarded for it or been afraid not to. As adults, we can feel responsible for everyone's feelings at holidays, in group chats, and in every decision, and exhausted by the effort.

What Scripture teaches

Proverbs says, "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high." Paul says, "If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone," which acknowledges that sometimes it is not possible. He also writes of seeking to please God and not people: "Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God?" and "each one should carry his own load." Jesus Himself "frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray," though people were still in need. Peacemaking is a calling. Keeping everyone happy is not.

> *"The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high"* (Proverbs 29:25).

Also see

> "If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone" (Romans 12:18).

> "Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ" (Galatians 1:10).

> "Yet He frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray" (Luke 5:16).

> "For each one should carry his own load" (Galatians 6:5).

Common self-statements

- If someone is upset, I must have done something.
- I cannot say no without causing a blowup.
- I have to make sure everyone has a good time.
- It is my job to keep the peace.
- I cannot relax until everyone is okay.
- Their moods are my responsibility.

Common logical errors

- Personalization: Treating other people's feelings as my responsibility.
- Mind reading: Trying to predict and manage everyone's reactions.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should keep everyone satisfied.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining that one unhappy person will ruin everything.

Challenging questions

- When did I first become the one who kept everyone happy?
- What do I fear will happen if someone is upset with me?

- What are others responsible for in managing their own feelings?
- What is the difference between peacemaking and people-pleasing?
- What would I do differently if I trusted God with the outcome?
- What is one small thing I can let others handle?

Truth summary

> I can be kind and a peacemaker without being responsible for everyone's happiness. Each person carries their own load, and God is the one I ultimately answer to. I can set small limits and trust God with how others respond.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Pride
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, For Others
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I have to keep everyone in my family happy"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I have to keep everyone in my family happy." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When did I become the peacekeeper?
- ☐ What do I fear?
- ☐ What are others responsible for?
- ☐ What is one thing I can release?
- ☐ How can I say no kindly?
- ☐ When can I be alone with God?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The fear of man is a snare.
- ☐ I can live at peace as far as it depends on me.
- ☐ Each person carries their own load.
- ☐ Peacemaking is not people-pleasing.
- ☐ Jesus withdrew to pray.
- ☐ I can trust God with others' reactions.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 29:25
  "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high."
- ☐ Romans 12:18
  "If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone."
- ☐ Galatians 6:5
  "For each one should carry his own load."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Let it be theirs: Each week, write one task or feeling you let someone else carry.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 29:25 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Trusting the Lord sets me securely on high, even when someone is unhappy.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List your duties. Write what you try to manage for others at gatherings.
- [ ] Release one. Choose one thing to hand to someone else this week.
- [ ] Practice a calm no. Rehearse a kind, short way to decline.
- [ ] Take time alone. Withdraw to pray, like Jesus did.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have to keep everyone in my family happy": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A load released
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have to keep everyone in my family happy.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have tried to keep everyone happy and I am worn out. Teach me to be a peacemaker without carrying what is not mine. Help me trust You with how others feel. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #18 · RELATIVES

“I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

In many families, one person ends up as the odd one out: the one who thinks differently, left the faith, made a different choice, or was blamed for the family’s problems. Years of being misunderstood, teased, or excluded can harden into the belief that we will never belong anywhere.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says, “God settles the lonely in families.” John writes, “to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God.” Paul says, “You received the Spirit of sonship… The Spirit Himself testifies with our spirit that we are God’s children.” Jesus said, “For whoever does the will of God is My brother and sister and mother.” Even if your family of origin has never made room for you, you have a place in God’s family, and He can provide people who welcome you.

> *“God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land”* (Psalm 68:6).

Also see

> “But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God” (John 1:12).

> “For you did not receive a spirit of slavery that returns you to fear, but you received the Spirit of sonship, by whom we cry, ‘Abba! Father!’ The Spirit Himself testifies with our spirit that we are God’s children” (Romans 8:15–16).

> “For whoever does the will of God is My brother and sister and mother” (Mark 3:35).

> “Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household” (Ephesians 2:19).

Common self-statements

- I will always be the outsider.
- They never understood me.
- There is something wrong with me.
- I do not belong in any family.
- I am the problem.
- Nobody will ever make room for me.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Calling myself “the black sheep.”
- Overgeneralizing: Treating one family’s rejection as universal.
- Personalization: Assuming I was the cause of the family’s difficulties.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never belong.

Challenging questions

- How did I come to be the odd one out in my family?

- Whose problems got pinned on me?
- In what ways might my differences be strengths?
- Where do I feel welcome, and what do those places have in common?
- What does God say about my place in His family?
- What community could I invest in this month?

Truth summary

> Being the odd one out in my family does not decide where I belong. God has made me His child, and He settles the lonely in families. I can find and build a family of faith and friendship who welcome me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How did I become the odd one out?
- ☐ What strengths do my differences bring?
- ☐ Where am I welcome?
- ☐ What does God say about my place?
- ☐ What group could I join?
- ☐ Who can I talk with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ I have the right to be a child of God.
- ☐ The Spirit testifies that I belong.
- ☐ I am part of Christ's family.
- ☐ My differences are not a defect.
- ☐ I can build a community.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 68:6
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."
- ☐ John 1:12
  "But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God."
- ☐ Mark 3:35
  "For whoever does the will of God is My brother and sister and mother."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Where I belong: Each week, note one place or person where you felt welcome.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 68:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God settles the lonely in families, and that includes me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the role. Write how you became "the black sheep" and whose idea it was.
- [ ] List your strengths. Write what makes you different and valuable.
- [ ] Join a group. Commit to a church group, class, or team for a few weeks.
- [ ] Read Psalm 68:5–6. Say it as a prayer.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A place I belong
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You settle the lonely in families. I have felt like an outsider for so long. Show me my place in Your family, and lead me to people who welcome me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #19 · RELATIVES

“Family means I must put up with anything.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Family loyalty is a gift, but it can be bent into a trap. Some of us were taught that family comes first no matter what, that we should never speak about problems outside the home, or that forgiving means staying in harm’s way. This teaching can keep people in verbal, emotional, financial, or physical mistreatment.

What Scripture teaches

Proverbs says, “The prudent see danger and take cover, but the simple keep going and suffer the consequences.” Jesus taught, “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately.” Paul says, “Speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ.” The psalmist calls us to “defend the cause of the weak and fatherless… Rescue the weak and needy.” God does not ask you to accept abuse in the name of family. Honoring family and protecting yourself can go together. If you are being harmed, safety comes first.

> *“The prudent see danger and take cover, but the simple keep going and suffer the consequences”* (Proverbs 22:3).

Also see

> “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over” (Matthew 18:15).

> “Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head” (Ephesians 4:15).

> “Defend the cause of the weak and fatherless; uphold the rights of the afflicted and oppressed. Rescue the weak and needy; save them from the hand of the wicked” (Psalm 82:3–4).

> “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone” (Romans 12:18).

Common self-statements

- Family always comes first, no matter what.
- I cannot say anything about how they treat me.
- Good family members take it.
- If I set limits, I am betraying them.
- What happens at home stays at home.
- They are my family, so I have to endure it.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Insisting that I must tolerate anything from family.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either accept everything or cut everyone off.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty about limits and concluding they are wrong.
- Minimizing: Treating harmful behavior as normal.

Challenging questions

- What behavior am I putting up with that hurts me or others?

- Where did I learn that loyalty means silence?
- What does Scripture say about protecting the vulnerable?
- What would a healthy limit look like?
- Who could I trust with the truth?
- Is anyone in danger now?

Truth summary

> Honoring my family does not mean accepting harm. I can speak the truth in love, set limits, and protect myself and others. If there is danger, I should seek safe help immediately.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Wisdom
- Child Abuse/Neglect
- Protection
- Communication
- Refuge/Safety

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Anger

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Same Power — Jeremy Camp
God's power challenges the belief that evil or fear has the final authority.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Family means I must put up with anything"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Family means I must put up with anything." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What am I putting up with?
- ☐ Where did I learn silence is loyal?
- ☐ What limit do I need?
- ☐ Who can I trust with the truth?
- ☐ Is anyone in danger?
- ☐ What is my safety plan?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The prudent take cover.
- ☐ I can speak the truth in love.
- ☐ Honoring family does not require accepting abuse.
- ☐ Protecting the vulnerable is God's heart.
- ☐ Limits can be loving.
- ☐ My safety matters.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 22:3
  "The prudent see danger and take cover, but the simple keep going and suffer the consequences."
- ☐ Matthew 18:15
  "If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over."
- ☐ Ephesians 4:15
  "Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A limit set: Each week, write one limit you set or one truth you spoke calmly.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 22:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The prudent take cover, and I can protect myself with God's wisdom.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Protection" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the behavior. Write specifically what happens and how it affects you.
- [ ] Talk to a safe person. Tell a pastor, counselor, or trusted friend what is happening.
- [ ] Plan a limit. Decide what you will and will not accept, and how to communicate it.
- [ ] Make a safety plan. If you or others are in danger, call 911 or the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 1-800-799-7233.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Family means I must put up with anything": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A limit set
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Family means I must put up with anything.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have been told to put up with things that hurt. Give me wisdom and courage to speak the truth, to protect myself and others, and to seek help where I need it. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #20 · RELATIVES

“I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

In many families one person becomes the fixer: the capable one who steps in with money, advice, rescues, or mediation. Often it begins in childhood, when a parent was overwhelmed. Over time, the role becomes identity, and we feel guilty when we cannot solve a problem or when others do not accept our help.

What Scripture teaches

Paul says, “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ,” and in the same chapter, “each one should carry his own load.” Both are true: we help, and each person remains responsible for their life. “Each of us will give an account of himself to God.” Jesus said, “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest… My burden is light.” The Lord is the Savior of your family. You are not.

> *“For each one should carry his own load”* (Galatians 6:5).

Also see

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “So then, each of us will give an account of himself to God” (Romans 14:12).

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light” (Matthew 11:28–30).

> “The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him” (Ezekiel 18:20).

Common self-statements

- If I do not step in, everything will fall apart.
- They need me to fix this.
- I am the only responsible one.
- It is my fault if they struggle.
- I cannot rest until it is solved.
- Who else will do it?

Common logical errors

- Personalization: Treating others’ problems as my responsibility.
- Magnification: Believing everything depends on me.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should rescue everyone.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining collapse if I step back.

Challenging questions

- When did I become the fixer, and why?
- Which problems are really mine, and which belong to others?

- What happens when I rescue repeatedly?
- What is the difference between helping and rescuing?
- What does Jesus invite me to do with my burden?
- What is one problem I can hand back or hand to God?

Truth summary

> I can help my family without being their savior. Each person carries their own load, and I can carry burdens with them in healthy ways. I can rest in Jesus, who is gentle, and trust Him with what I cannot fix.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Servant
- Pride
- Trust
- Tired

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Oh My Soul — Casting Crowns
Honest distress can coexist with faith and hope in God.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When did I become the fixer?
- ☐ Which problems are mine?
- ☐ What does rescuing cost?
- ☐ How can I help without fixing?
- ☐ What can I hand to God?
- ☐ Where can I rest?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Each person carries their own load.
- ☐ Helping is not the same as rescuing.
- ☐ Jesus gives me rest.
- ☐ I am not the Savior of my family.
- ☐ I can say no to some requests.
- ☐ God is able to work in their lives.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:5
  "For each one should carry his own load."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Matthew 11:28–30
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

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- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Handed back: Each week, write one problem you handed back to its owner or to God.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Each person carries their own load, and I can trust God with my family.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
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- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Sort the problems. List family problems and mark whose they are.
- ☐ Hand one back. Choose one problem to return kindly to its owner.
- ☐ Offer help differently. Offer listening or prayer instead of fixing.
- ☐ Rest in Matthew 11:28–30. Read it slowly and pray it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

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My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, I have tried to carry my family. I give You the burdens I cannot fix. Teach me to help with wisdom, to hand back what is theirs, and to rest in You. Amen.

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